

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- ✓ Complete Answer Key
- ✓ Full Lesson Plan
- ✓ Common Student Mistakes
- ✓ Teacher Tip
- ✓ Extra Class Activity
- ✓ Extension & Exit Ticket

WORKSHEET INFORMATION

LEVEL	A1
SKILL	Writing
TOPIC	Joining ideas in writing with and, but, because, so, or, when, before, after
EXERCISES	6 (1–6)
EST. TIME	40–45 minutes
ANSWER KEY	Included above

ANSWER KEY

1. Complete and Write

Students choose a conjunction from the box and finish each sentence with their own idea; several gaps allow more than one conjunction. Best fit: 1 and, 2 but / so, 3 because, 4 so, 5 or, 6 before, 7 and / after, 8 because / when. Check the two halves make sense together.

2. Look and Write

Personal answers – one complete sentence per picture using the conjunction in brackets: 1 (because) e.g. *He is studying because he has a test.* 2 (and) *She is eating a sandwich and drinking juice.* 3 (after) *They went for a walk after school.* 4 (so) *The dog was hungry, so it ate.*

3. Join the Ideas

1. I was hungry, so we made a sandwich.
2. She didn't want to go because it was cold outside.
3. We watched a movie and ate popcorn.
4. After I got home, I did my homework. (also: I did my homework after I got home.)
5. Do you like tea or coffee?
6. He missed the bus, so he was late.

4. Put the Words in Order

1. I brush my teeth after breakfast.
2. It was raining, but we went for a walk.
3. We went home when it was dark.
4. She likes cats, but she prefers dogs.
5. I study because I want good grades.
6. We played games and had dinner.

5. Complete the Paragraph

- | | |
|------------|-----------------|
| 1. because | 5. and |
| 2. before | 6. but |
| 3. so | 7. before / and |
| 4. but | 8. After |

Conjunctions may repeat. Fixed: 1 because, 3 so, 4 & 6 but, 8 After. Gaps 5 and 7 accept any conjunction that fits the sense.

6. Write about You

Personal answers (4–5 sentences about your day, weekend or a favourite activity, at least 3 conjunctions). Use the checklist: 3+ conjunctions, complete sentences, own ideas.

TEACHING SUPPORT

TEACHER TIP

The box gives eight conjunctions but students only need to ask two questions: what is the relationship (adding / contrast / reason / result / choice / time)? and does a comma go before it (usually before 'but' and 'so')? Put those two questions on the board.

COMMON STUDENT MISTAKES

- X I was hungry so, we made a sandwich.
- ✓ I was hungry, so we made a sandwich.
- X She didn't go, it was cold.
- ✓ She didn't go because it was cold.
- X Do you like tea and coffee? (choice)
- ✓ Do you like tea or coffee?
- X After I got home I did my homework.
- ✓ After I got home, I did my homework.

EXTRA CLASS ACTIVITY

Sentence Builder Dice (8 min)

In groups, students have two piles of sentence halves and a list of conjunctions. They draw two halves, pick a conjunction that joins them logically, and write the full sentence with correct punctuation. One point per correct, sensible sentence.

LEARNING FOCUS

Objective: Students will be able to join two short ideas into one written sentence using and, but, because, so, or and time conjunctions, with correct commas, and produce a short connected paragraph.

Success Criteria: I can choose the right conjunction for the meaning (adding, contrast, reason, result, choice, time). I can join two sentences into one. I can put a comma before 'but' and 'so', and after a fronted time / condition clause.

Prior Knowledge: The meaning of and, but, because, so, or and before / after / when (from the practice and reading worksheets); simple present and past sentences.

LESSON PLAN (40–45 MINUTES)

Level: A1

Skill: Writing

Topic: Joining ideas in writing with and, but, because, so, or, when, before, after

Exercises: 6 (1–6)

Est. Time: 40–45 minutes

MATERIALS & PREP

- Printed worksheet copies (1 per student)
- Board for the 8 conjunctions grouped by function

- Pens or pencils

TIME	STAGE	PROCEDURE
5 min	Warm-Up	Write two sentences: 'I was tired.' 'I finished my homework.' Ask students to join them two different ways ('... but I finished...' / '... so I stopped...'). Show how the conjunction changes the meaning.
12 min	Presentation (I Do)	Group the eight conjunctions on the board by job: add = and; contrast = but; reason = because; result = so; choice = or; time = when, before, after. One model each, joining two clauses. Punctuation: a comma before 'but' and 'so' ('It was late, so we went home.'). a comma after a fronted time / 'if' clause ('After I got home, I rested.'). Model Exercise 3 item 1: 'I was hungry.' + 'We made a sandwich.' + (so) → 'I was hungry, so we made a sandwich.' Point out that 'so' puts the cause first and the result second.
12 min	Guided Practice (We Do)	Exercise 3 items 1–3 together: label the relationship, choose the conjunction, add the comma, check the sense. Do Exercise 4 item 1 as a class.
10 min	Independent Practice (You Do)	Students complete Exercise 3, Exercise 4 (order the words) and Exercise 5 (paragraph) alone; compare Exercise 4 in pairs, checking commas.
6 min	Assessment	Review Exercise 4 on the board: students read the sentence, name the conjunction and its job, and say if a comma is needed. Students complete the Exit Ticket individually.
5 min	Closure	Students write the first two sentences of Exercise 6 and read them to a partner, who counts the conjunctions and checks the commas.

FOLLOW-UP / HOMEWORK IDEA

Homework: finish the Exercise 6 paragraph (4–5 sentences, 3+ conjunctions), then underline each conjunction and label its job.

ANTICIPATED PROBLEMS & SOLUTIONS

Problem: Students put the comma after the conjunction ('I was tired so, I stopped') instead of before it.

Solution: Show the rule on the board with a big comma before 'so' / 'but'; have students point to where the comma goes before writing.

Problem: Students use 'so' and 'because' the wrong way round ('It was cold, because I stayed home').

Solution: Teach the order: cause + so + result; result + because + cause. Ask 'what happened first?' before they write.

FOR EXTRA SUPPORT

Give weaker students Exercises 3 and 5 with the relationship labelled (reason / result / time...) so they only choose the matching conjunction.

FOR AN EXTRA CHALLENGE

Students rewrite three Exercise 4 sentences, changing the conjunction to a different one that still works and adjusting the order and punctuation.

EXTENSION & FAST-FINISHER IDEAS

- Write one sentence that uses two conjunctions.

- Change 'because' to 'so' in one sentence and reorder it.

LANGUAGE FOCUS & BOARD NOTES

Grammar: and / but / because / so / or + time conjunctions when / before / after; comma before 'but' and 'so' and after a fronted clause.

Board: I was hungry, so we made a sandwich. • She likes cats, but she prefers dogs. • After I got home, I did my homework.

EXIT TICKET — QUICK CHECK

1. Join: 'It was raining.' + 'We went for a walk.' (but) → *It was raining, but we went for a walk.*

2. Choose: I study ____ I want good grades. → *because*

3. Add the comma: After I got home I did my homework. → *After I got home, I did my homework.*

TEACHER REFLECTION:

☐ What worked well? ☐ What didn't work? ☐ Who needed extra support? ☐ What will I change next time?